Jessica Macdonald

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Professional Summary

A friendly, approachable, well-rounded individual intending a career in the legal profession.

Education

Bachelor of Laws And Bachelor of Science: Majoring in Psychology
University Of Canterbury - Christchurch, Canterbury
Third year student. Majoring in Psychology as it is not only interesting to understanding human behaviour, but is fundamental to understanding clients different personas and needs in the legal profession. Side interest in statistical analysis.

NCEA Levels 1, 2 And 3: 11/2016
John Paul College - Rotorua - Rotorua, Bay Of Plenty
Graduated in 2016 as Head Girl , receiving the prestigious ‘Lasallian Award' recognising success in ‘all-round' achievement , in particular community service. Excellence Endorsement in Levels 2 and 3, along with achieving NCEA Scholarship Chemistry.

Awards

- **Prime Minister Scholarship** for Asia recipient 2020
- **1st Place** in the "Karma Cola Problem Solver" **Business Consulting Competition 2019**
- **2nd Place** in the University of Canterbury **Client Interviewing Competition 2019**
- **2nd Place** in the University of Canterbury **Junior Negotiation Competition 2019**
- University of Canterbury **Certificate in Legal Research Skills**
- Prestigious **'Rotorua Young Achiever'** Award for Academic Achievement, Leadership and Community Service
- Rotorua Energy Charitable Trust Tertiary Scholarship
- University of Canterbury 'Emerging Leaders' Scholarship
- University of Canterbury Excellence Scholarship
- University of Otago "Leaders of Tomorrow" Entrance Scholarship
- **Head Girl** of John Paul College 2016

Skills

- **Excellent Communication Skills-** I know how to adapt my language for the intended audience to ensure they understand what I am communicating. Recognised through involvement with the 'Prison Project' and 'Family Legal Advice Clinic'
- **Team Player-** Learnt from extensive and diverse job history and team sports
- **Leadership-** Recognised through President of Law for Change 2020, Vice President of Eco Club, Head
- **Organisation and Time Management**- Necessary to manage large workload, extra curricular and social involvement
- **Client Interaction and Assessment-** Professional with clients, along with good intrinsic analytical skills. Recognised through award in Client Interviewing Competition
- **Proficient Research Skills-** Received UC Legal Research skills certificate

Girl and '180 Degrees' leadership position

Extra-Curricular Involvement

- **Family Legal Advice Clinic (2019)**
  Fortnightly service run by Community Law Canterbury involving initial client assessment with a practicing solicitor, recording material information and advice, then completing and submitting legal applications
- **Prison Project Volunteer (2019)**
  Community Law and Department of Corrections Volunteer Role, where 3 other students and myself run educational legal seminars fortnightly in the Male Youth Unit in the Christchurch Prison. Requires a high level of patience and excellent communication skills
- **Secretary of Law for Change UC 2019 (President 2020)**
  Strong belief in providing students with the opportunity to gain practical work experience, and in particular using their acquired legal knowledge for the benefit of the community
- **180 Consultant and 'Team Leader' (2019)**
  Project leader for non- profit organisation, creating new volunteer schemes, and re-evaluating advertisement strategies. Includes professional interaction with clients. The role of team leader demands a high level of organisational, time management and conflict resolution skills
- **Vice President of University of Canterbury's "Eco Club Network" (2019)**
  Passion for creating a sustainable campus at UC
- **General Executive Member of University of Canterbury Women in Law Society (2019)**
  Empowering women in the legal profession
- **Law Revue Cast Member (2018)**
  Performing with UC Law Students at annual musical
- **Camp Quality Companion (2017- Present)**
  Camp Quality is an organisation which runs camps for children living with cancer. These camps aim to create a fun and highly positive environment, to let the campers just feel like a regular kid. The companion role consists of providing one-to-one support to a camper for the week of camp and beyond, ensuring that they have a wonderful experience
- **Fulfill Van Volunteer Co-Ordinator (2016)**

Work History

Academic Tutor, 07/2019 to Current
Bishop Julius Hall Of Residence – Christchurch, Canterbury
Tutoring students in first year law.

LawMe Mentor, 02/2019 to Current
University Of Canterbury Law School – Christchurch
Employed by the *University of Canterbury Law School* as a mentor to a group of 25 first year students. This role includes academic and social guidance, and requires strong communication skills.

Criminal Barrister Fellowship, 11/2017 to 02/2019
GISELE SCHWEIZER Criminal Barrister – Rotorua
Assisted a Local Barrister in interviewing clients whilst on duty in Rotorua District Court. The role consisted of interacting with clients, acquiring material facts about the case, along with assisting in filling out legal aid applications. Gained invaluable experience observing legal procedure.

Giselle Schweizer: 027 232 3211

Waitress, 11/2018 to 02/2019
Stratosfare Restaurant (Skyline Rotorua) – Rotorua, Bay Of Plenty

Kitchen Hand, 02/2017 to 06/2018
Bishop Julius Hall Of Residence – Christchurch, Canterbury

Waitress, 11/2017 to 02/2018
Capers Epicurean – Rotorua, Bay Of Plenty

Customer Service, 11/2016 to 02/2017
McDonald's – Rotorua, Bay Of Plenty

Hobbies

I am a keen runner and skier, and love to explore the fantastic landscape that Canterbury has to offer. I also enjoy musical theatre and painting in my spare time.

References

Leticia Glover
'Prison Project' Management
027 582 1661